



ReGen Civics Quest Field Guide

Nonviolent Communication

regencivics.earth

What This Quest Is

Learn and practice Nonviolent Communication — the framework that bridges personal healing into collective co-creation. This is the language of needs, not judgments. The bridge from individual healing into collective co-creation.

Story Card

Marshall Rosenberg spent decades studying what happens when people speak to each other honestly. Most of what we call communication is not really communication at all. It is demands, evaluations, comparisons, and punishments dressed up as conversation. NVC offers a different grammar: observations instead of evaluations, feelings instead of interpretations, needs instead of demands, requests instead of commands. This matters enormously for the ReGen Civics game. We are trying to build new organizations, governance structures, communities. All of them will have conflict. NVC is the practice that can hold that complexity without collapsing into punishment and blame.

How To Do This Quest

Step 1: Take the NVC course.

Find the recommended NVC materials and watch the course. Online courses, Rosenberg's books, and free recordings of his workshops are all valid.

Step 2: Practice the four components.

Observation. Feeling. Need. Request. Apply them in your daily conversations. Start with low-stakes situations first.

Step 3: Find a practice partner.

NVC practiced alone is limited. Find someone to study and practice with. Many cities have NVC practice circles. Or seek a partner in our forum.

Step 4: Apply in a real situation.

Bring NVC into a genuine conflict or tension in your life. Not to win. To connect.

Step 5: Reflect and share.

Write or record a reflection on what you learned. What shifted? Where did it get hard? What would you tell someone just starting?

Step 6: Attend or host a community session.

The forum has regular NVC discussion threads. Participate. If there is not a session happening, start one.

Deliverable

A written reflection, video, or recorded conversation showing your NVC practice and what it opened up.

Tips

- The hardest part: distinguishing observations from evaluations. Practice this first.
- 'I feel like you don't care about me' is not a feeling. It is an interpretation. 'I feel hurt and lonely' is a feeling.
- Gratitude is also NVC. Practice expressing gratitude in terms of what needs were met.

Resources

- Nonviolent Communication: A Language of Life by Marshall Rosenberg (book)
- NVC Academy: nvctraining.com
- Center for Nonviolent Communication: cnvc.org
- Gabor Mate on trauma and communication: youtube.com/playlist?list=PL3Xi8vZSmBTRID8Dnx6a16yeBTaSxKNdS

A Place to Write

Observations, feelings, needs, and requests you are practicing:
